

Corrective PRD / Agent Injection Prompt

Magnifica Humanitas — Material Regression Fix & Heraldic Authority Pass

Role

You are Claude 4.8 acting as a senior front-end implementation agent and visual craft corrector.

You are working on:

`https://augustave.github.io/magnifica/`

This is a corrective pass after the previous “Heraldic Materiality” implementation.

The previous pass completed the requested features, but the visual result is not yet acceptable. It introduced some digital-looking material effects that weaken the site’s authority.

Your task is to correct the material language.

Do not restructure the site.

Do not add new UX sections.

Do not rewrite content.

This is a focused visual correction pass.

1. Current Problem

The site architecture is correct. The Hybrid spine has landed.

The problem is visual taste and material execution.

The previous implementation introduced:

- Yellowish rounded gradients on cards and controls.
- Digitally glossy “gold” effects that do not read as real antique gold.
- Seal dots / circular gradients that feel fake and ornamental in the wrong way.
- Buttons that now feel stylized but still digital.

- Ornament and frames that still do not feel like real gold, foil, metal, or embroidery.
- A cross / wreath emblem that remains too faded, flat, and weak.
- Cards that are more visible, but feel less organic and less paper-crafted.
- A general shift away from the original handmade paper mood.

The correction is not to add more effects.

The correction is to remove the fake digital materiality and replace it with disciplined heraldic craft.

2. Desired Direction

The site should feel like:

- A ceremonial ecclesial document.
- Printed parchment with mounted bookplates.
- Gold ink / foil applied through engraved linework.
- Heraldic insignia built from clear vector geometry.
- Archival labels attached to paper.
- A papal document with operational doctrine instruments.

The site should not feel like:

- A 2000s web graphic.
 - A CSS gradient experiment.
 - A fake gold Photoshop effect.
 - A UI kit with decorative cards.
 - A sticker pack.
 - A fantasy-game menu.
 - A “royal” template.
-

3. Core Correction Principle

The previous pass tried to make things material through gradients.

That is the wrong approach.

Use this principle instead:

Materiality through edge, line, grain, pressure, and hierarchy — not gloss.

Good material cues:

- crisp antique-gold linework
- thin double borders
- engraved hatching
- slight ink misregistration
- paper fiber texture
- restrained shadow only as pressure
- embossed / debossed edges
- small blue/crimson registration marks
- restored ornamental frames

Bad material cues:

- radial yellow gradients
 - shiny circular seals
 - glossy gold text gradients everywhere
 - blurry halos
 - fake bevels
 - strong digital shadows
 - overly rounded highlights
 - generic sticker effects
-

4. Hard Reversal Requirements

Remove or neutralize the following

- Remove yellow circular seal-dot gradients from cards unless they are extremely subtle and non-glossy.
- Remove “round yellow gradient” effects from cards and buttons.
- Remove any fake glossy gold look from card numerals if it feels plastic.
- Remove excessive gradient shine from buttons.
- Remove any decorative effect that looks like a digital badge.
- Do not use heavy `radial-gradient()` for gold ornament unless it is masked into subtle paper texture.

Preserve

- Hybrid architecture.
- All content.
- Current sections.

- Sidebar and dropdown navigation.
 - Copy button functionality.
 - Mobile responsiveness.
 - Existing paper background.
 - The more ceremonial drop caps, but refine if needed.
-

5. Gold Correction

Problem

Gold currently appears only on some numerals, and the actual ornaments / frames still do not read as real gold. Some added gold reads fake.

Corrective Goal

Gold should read as antique ink / foil / embroidery through linework and contrast, not through obvious glossy gradients.

Replace broad gradient gold with disciplined antique-gold tokens

Use a flatter, more credible palette:

```
:root {  
  --gold-ink: #b8933f;  
  --gold-dark: #6f501b;  
  --gold-light: #d8bd6a;  
  --gold-hairline: rgba(184, 147, 63, 0.62);  
  --gold-soft: rgba(184, 147, 63, 0.22);  
}
```

Use gold mostly as line, not fill

Apply gold to:

- frames
- rules
- ornaments
- Roman numerals
- section dividers
- small caps
- crest outline
- drop cap border details

Do not apply glossy gold gradients to large text blocks or broad card surfaces.

Create an engraved gold rule system

Use double-line borders and inner hairlines.

Example direction:

```
.gold-frame {  
  border: 1px solid var(--gold-hairline);  
  box-shadow:  
    inset 0 0 0 1px rgba(255, 250, 225, 0.45),  
    inset 0 0 0 4px rgba(184, 147, 63, 0.08);  
}
```

Add subtle engraved texture only where useful

If using texture, keep it almost invisible.

Acceptable:

```
background-image:  
  linear-gradient(rgba(184,147,63,.08), rgba(184,147,63,.08)),  
  repeating-linear-gradient(  
    45deg,  
    rgba(255,255,255,.05) 0,  
    rgba(255,255,255,.05) 1px,  
    transparent 1px,  
    transparent 4px  
  );
```

Do not use glossy gradients as the main effect.

Acceptance Criteria

- Gold ornaments and frames read stronger than before.
- Gold no longer looks yellow, plastic, or digital.
- Gold is primarily line-based, engraved, or foil-edged.
- The visual language feels closer to antique print / embroidery than web gloss.

6. Restore and Strengthen Ornament / Frame System

Problem

The original ornaments and frames were not upgraded enough. The site still lacks the ceremonial frame authority seen in the Cape reference.

Goal

Make ornament and framing feel more deliberate and heraldic.

Requirements

- Identify existing ornamental rules, dividers, borders, and frames.
- Strengthen them using gold linework, not glow.
- Add double-rule treatments to major sections.
- Use small symmetrical flourishes where already present.
- Restore any pre-pass decorative clarity that was lost.
- Make section boundaries feel like printed plates.

Specific areas to upgrade

- Cover frame
- Incipit area
- Summa frame
- Reader Path cards
- Five Principles section
- Doctrine Map
- Apply the Doctrine section
- Governance Gates
- Five Red Lines
- Export cards
- Conclusion signature area

Acceptance Criteria

- Frames feel intentional and ceremonial.
 - Ornaments are visible but restrained.
 - Gold frame work is stronger than before.
 - No “busy wallpaper” effect.
-

7. Card Correction: From Fake Stickers to Bookplates

Problem

Cards now have a yellow rounded gradient / fake sticker feel.

Goal

Cards should feel like mounted bookplates or archival paper slips attached to real paper.

Not glossy stickers.

Remove

- Yellow round gradients.
- Glossy seal dots.
- Obvious corner sticker tabs if they feel cute.
- Fake radial highlights.
- Strong rounded ornamentation.

Replace with

- Slight paper value shift.
- Crisp rectangular edge.
- Thin blue or gold border.
- Inner hairline.
- Very subtle pressed edge.
- Optional tiny registration mark, not decorative seal.
- Minimal paper grain.

Card Style Direction

Cards should feel:

- dry
- printed
- archival
- tactile
- restrained
- mounted

They should not feel:

- shiny
- cute
- bubbly
- gradient-heavy
- sticker-pack-like

Suggested CSS direction

```
.archival-card,  
.mode,  
.path,  
.pcard,  
.dcol,  
.gate,  
.xcard {  
  background:  
    linear-gradient(  
      180deg,  
      rgba(248, 243, 229, 0.96),  
      rgba(239, 232, 213, 0.94)  
    );  
  border: 1px solid rgba(24, 62, 110, 0.18);  
  outline: 1px solid rgba(184, 147, 63, 0.28);  
  box-shadow:  
    inset 0 0 0 1px rgba(255, 252, 241, 0.58),  
    inset 0 -1px 0 rgba(100, 76, 34, 0.10);  
}
```

Inner hairline:

```
.archival-card::before,  
.mode::before,  
.path::before,  
.pcard::before,  
.dcol::before,  
.gate::before,  
.xcard::before {  
  content: "";  
  position: absolute;  
  inset: 7px;  
  pointer-events: none;
```



```
border: 1px solid rgba(184, 147, 63, 0.18);
}
```

Registration mark option:

```
.archival-card::after,  
.path::after,  
.pcard::after {  
  content: "";  
  position: absolute;  
  top: 12px;  
  right: 12px;  
  width: 6px;  
  height: 6px;  
  border: 1px solid rgba(184, 147, 63, .55);  
  background: transparent;  
}
```

Use this instead of a filled radial seal.

Acceptance Criteria

- Cards no longer have yellow circular fake gradients.
- Cards feel like paper bookplates.
- Card boundaries are visible.
- Background remains organic.
- No generic drop shadow.
- No fake sticker shine.

8. Buttons Correction

Problem

Buttons now look stylized but still too digitally “gold button” / control-like.

Goal

Buttons should look like small printed archival labels.

Remove

- rounded yellow gradient feel

- fake shine
- heavy button-like depth

Replace with

- flat ivory paper fill
- blue text
- gold hairline border
- small-caps type
- subtle pressed inset

Button Direction

```
.btn-copy,  
.qbar button,  
.export-action,  
.copy-button {  
  background: rgba(246, 240, 222, 0.86);  
  border: 1px solid rgba(184, 147, 63, 0.42);  
  color: var(--royal-blue);  
  box-shadow:  
    inset 0 0 0 1px rgba(255, 252, 241, 0.55);  
  text-transform: uppercase;  
  letter-spacing: 0.11em;  
}
```

Hover:

```
.btn-copy:hover,  
.qbar button:hover {  
  background: rgba(251, 246, 232, 0.98);  
  border-color: rgba(184, 147, 63, 0.72);  
}
```

No glossy gradients.

Acceptance Criteria

- Buttons look printed, not glossy.
- Copy feedback still works.
- Keyboard focus remains visible.
- Buttons feel native to the paper system.

9. Cross / Wreath Emblem Rebuild

Problem

The emblem still looks faded, flat, and weak. Increasing opacity did not solve it.

Goal

Rebuild or restyle the emblem as a proper heraldic insignia.

The problem is not just opacity. It is construction.

Requirements

The emblem should have:

- clearer cross silhouette
- cleaner wreath geometry
- stronger antique-gold or blue-gold outline
- possible crimson center field
- less “transparent blob” feeling
- more crest / medallion logic

Preferred Direction

Do not simply raise opacity again.

Create or modify the SVG so it has:

1. Outer laurel wreath linework.
2. Central cross with clear arms.
3. Optional quatrefoil / shield form behind cross.
4. Gold outline with dark blue shadow.
5. Minimal fill.
6. Better contrast against royal blue.

Visual rule

The emblem should read even when squinting.

If it only appears as a vague watermark, it fails.

Possible implementation

Use the current SVG as a base, but separate:

- wreath stroke
- cross stroke / fill
- central field
- shadow layer

Then style with CSS variables.

Example direction:

```
.hero-emblem .wreath {  
  stroke: rgba(216, 189, 106, 0.42);  
  fill: none;  
}  
  
.hero-emblem .cross {  
  fill: rgba(216, 189, 106, 0.34);  
  stroke: rgba(111, 80, 27, 0.22);  
}  
  
.hero-emblem .field {  
  fill: rgba(8, 18, 34, 0.14);  
}
```

If the current emblem cannot be cleanly improved, create a new simplified SVG crest.

Acceptance Criteria

- Cross is legible.
- Wreath is legible.
- Emblem feels heraldic, not like a faded background blob.
- It has more authority but does not overpower the title.
- It matches the Cape reference more closely.

10. Drop Cap Refinement

Problem

The ceremonial drop caps are directionally correct, but avoid making them feel too CSS-box-like.

Goal

Drop caps should feel like illuminated initials printed into the document.

Requirements

- Crimson letter remains.
- Gold should support the letter through hairline, not fake shine.
- Frame should be subtle and manuscript-like.
- Avoid heavy boxed appearance if it feels too UI-like.

Direction

Use:

- crimson initial
- antique gold hairline border
- very pale parchment fill
- slight inset print feel

Avoid:

- fake bevel
- thick box
- overly modern square badge

Acceptance Criteria

- Drop caps look ceremonial.
 - They do not look like UI badges.
 - Mobile remains readable.
-

11. Five Red Lines Refinement

Current Direction

Roman numerals are good. Keep them.

Problem

Make sure the gold numerals do not look fake.

Requirements

- Use flat antique gold ink.
- Add separators as thin gold rules.
- Keep judicial weight.
- Avoid glossy numeral gradients.

Acceptance Criteria

- Red Lines feel carved / printed.
 - Not shiny.
 - Not fantasy-like.
 - Very readable.
-

12. QA / Taste Gate

Before finishing, run this taste gate:

Question 1

Does any element look like a CSS gradient effect from the 2000s?

If yes, remove or flatten it.

Question 2

Does the gold look like yellow plastic?

If yes, replace with antique-gold linework.

Question 3

Do the cards look like stickers?

If yes, make them bookplates.

Question 4

Does the cross emblem read clearly?

If no, rebuild the SVG or simplify the mark.

Question 5

Do the ornaments and frames feel stronger than before?

If no, strengthen linework and frame hierarchy.

Question 6

Does the page still feel organic and paper-crafted?

If no, reduce digital effects.

13. Implementation Sequence

Follow this sequence:

1. Inspect current `assets/styles.css` and identify the previous pass additions.
2. Remove or neutralize radial yellow gradient effects.
3. Flatten glossy gold treatments into antique-gold ink / linework.
4. Replace card “seal dot” or fake sticker effects with bookplate framing.
5. Restyle buttons as flat archival labels.
6. Strengthen ornamental frames and rules.
7. Rework cross / wreath emblem beyond opacity adjustment.
8. Refine drop caps to avoid UI-badge feeling.
9. Keep Red Line Roman numerals but flatten the gold.
10. Run mobile and desktop checks.
11. Confirm no anchor / copy / navigation regression.

14. Files Likely Changed

Likely files:

- `assets/styles.css`
- `index.html` only if the emblem SVG or markup requires refinement
- SVG asset file if the crest exists separately

Do not touch `script.js` unless button behavior broke.

15. Acceptance Criteria

This pass is successful when:

- The site feels more organic than the previous version.
 - Cards are more visible without looking digitally glossy.
 - Gold ornaments and frames feel more real and ceremonial.
 - Gold is not yellow, shiny, or plastic.
 - Buttons feel printed, not glossy.
 - The cross / wreath emblem is materially stronger and more heraldic.
 - Drop caps feel illuminated, not like UI badges.
 - The original paper atmosphere is preserved.
 - The site feels closer to the Cape Art Direction System.
 - No structure or content is changed.
 - No mobile overflow.
 - No console errors.
 - Copy buttons still work.
-

16. Final Report Format

When complete, report:

```
## Completed
```

- Flattened fake gold gradients
- Reworked cards from stickers to bookplates
- Strengthened ornament / frame treatment
- Rebuilt or improved crest emblem
- Refined buttons and drop caps

```
## Files Changed
```

- file path
- file path

```
## QA
```

- desktop
- mobile
- navigation
- copy buttons
- console

Notes

- Any remaining taste-tunable values
- Any emblem/SVG limitations

Final Instruction

Do not make the site more decorated.

Make it more credible.

The target is not “gold effect.”

The target is **authority through material restraint**.

The site should feel printed, mounted, edged, and sealed — not generated by CSS shine.